

Rafael Gilt

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling pressured you to soften a conservation report showing that one supposedly untouched object had been recently altered. He threatened to replace you with a private conservator if you refused.

What you are hiding

You changed the date on a minor treatment record last month to spare the museum an embarrassing insurance dispute. No object was harmed, but the falsification could end your career. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Find out whether Calvin has noticed the altered treatment date.
- Ask Marcus what he thinks the Star Bowl's modern adhesive means.
- Keep the insurance issue separate from the murder investigation.

What you know about other guests

- Celeste quietly commissioned an outside provenance review despite pressure to stop asking questions.
- Calvin concealed a small installation crack until you could inspect it after opening night.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

You had legitimate access to the conservation cabinet. During the entire poison window, the Conservation Lab data logger records a sequence of manual humidity-calibration entries under your personal code at the case across the house. The log clears your timing but also exposes the treatment record whose date you altered.

IF MURDERER

You took the toxin sample from the conservation cabinet earlier. At 6:42, while carrying a condition-report folder to Sterling, you added it to his cordial and disposed of the stopper in your glove pouch.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I falsified a treatment date to avoid an insurance fight. That was wrong, and Sterling knew enough to threaten me with it. The Conservation Lab data logger records my manual calibration entries throughout the poison window. I was hiding bad paperwork, not handling Sterling's glass.

IF MURDERER

Sterling wanted conservation to become theater: clean labels, clean stories, no inconvenient evidence. The toxin was already in my care. I brought him the report, poisoned the cordial, and left with the same steady hands I use on fragile things every day. I preserve objects for a living. I decided Sterling Voss was not one of them.